The salary, allowances and other service conditions of the Chief Information Commissioner and an Information Commissioner shall be such as prescribed by the Central Government. But, they cannot be varied to his/her disadvantage during service.

Powers And Functions

The powers and functions of the Central Information Commission are:

1. It is the duty of the Commission to receive and inquire into a complaint from any person:
    1. who has not been able to submit an information request because of non-appointment of a Public Information Officer;
    2. who has been refused information that was requested;
    3. who has not received response to his/her information request within the specified time limits;
    4. who thinks the fees charged are unreasonable;
    5. who thinks information given is incomplete, misleading or false; and
    6. any other matter relating to obtaining information.
2. The Commission can order inquiry into any matter if there are reasonable grounds (suo-moto power).
3. While inquiring, the Commission has the powers of a civil court in respect of the following matters:
    1. summoning and enforcing attendance of persons and compelling them to give oral or written evidence on oath and to produce documents or things;
    2. requiring the discovery and inspection of documents;
    3. receiving evidence on affidavit;
    4. requisitioning any public record from any court or office;
    5. issuing summons for examination of witnesses or documents; and
    6. any other matter which may be prescribed.
4. During the inquiry of a complaint, the Commission may examine any record which is under the control of the public authority and no such record may be withheld from it on any grounds. In other words, all public records must be given to the Commission during inquiry for examination.
5. The Commission has the power to secure compliance of its decisions from the public authority. This includes:
    1. providing access to information in a particular form;
    2. directing the public authority to appoint a Public Information Officer where none exists;